Commissioner in an objectionable manner while he was driving around Dhaka in pursuance of his normal and legitimate functions. The High Commissioner (Dubey) stopped his car, and asked his security guard to request the occupants of the car following him not to do so. This resulted in an altercation, which has since been exaggerated in the Bangladesh press. Unfounded allegations were also made that the High Commissioner was interfering in the domestic affairs of Bangladesh.

The issue of intense surveillance was taken up at the highest level in the Bangladesh government and Ershad was warned that any other similar incident may jeopardise the relationship between the two countries. A R&AW officer said the active tailing of Indian officers stopped for some time but resumed after a few months.

On 25 March 1982, Ershad announced the suspension of the constitution and the dissolution of the civil administration and parliament while declaring martial law. He became de facto chief martial law administrator, arguing that the action was necessary due to the critical state of the country and economy. In his address on Bangladesh radio, Ershad promised to hold elections after the situation improved.

Exploiting Weakness

'Winds are a significant element of weather in Bangladesh,' a CIA report once stated. The American analysts were right. A thunderstorm had brought misfortune to the once all-powerful BNP and the rainfall had helped Ershad harvest riches. By this time, the R&AW had increased the recruitment and deployment of human sources in Bangladesh. The operation was more about collecting intelligence inside the opaque military